MOUNTAIN REVIEW
MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION NEWSLETTER
Volume IV Issue IV Fall 2014

HIGHLIGHTS

Summer Snapshots



Photos from our 60th Anniversary BBQ!
Page 5

Street Talk


ister-Leader
WHERE DID PALMITA PARK GET THE NAMES FOR ITS STREETS?

Learn the history behind the names of the streets in the 90 year old Palmita Park subdivision.
Page 6

Fall Event Preview



Our Fall 2014 meeting/ event celebrating NASA Ames's 75th is just around the corner!
Page 7

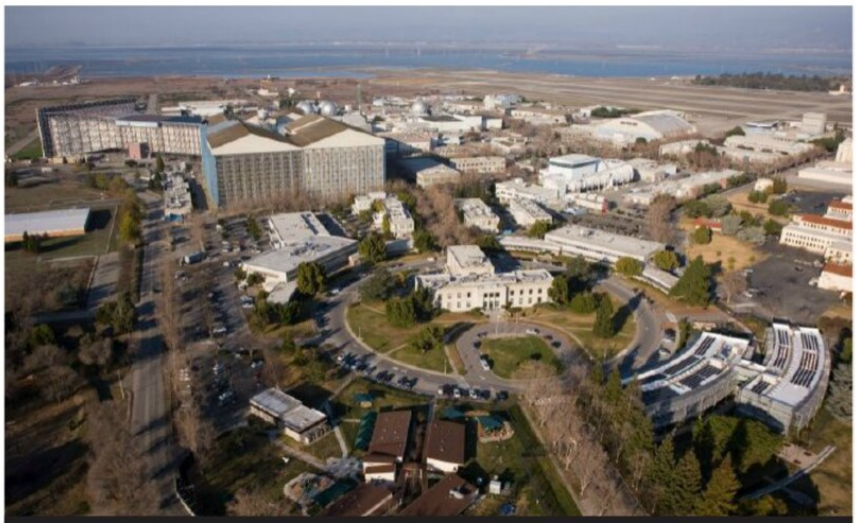
CONTENTS

News & Notes 2
Street Talk 4
Volunteer Opportunities 4
Fall Events 8



MVHA Fall Event & Membership Meeting

75 Years of NASA Ames



Modern View of NASA Ames Research Center - Looking North Toward SF Bay



Circa 1939 View of Ames's Construction - Looking West Toward Mtn. View

NASA Ames Research Center in Mountain View turns 75 years old this year! Founded on December 20, 1939, Ames has long been a national center of innovation and research. The two photos above (Courtesy NASA) show how much has changed since Ames was first built in the late 1930s. To celebrate its anniversary Ames is having its first public open house since 1997. Tickets to the mid-October event sold out in three days. But even if you weren't one of the lucky 120,000, you can still celebrate Ames's rich history by attending our November meeting. For more info. see Page 6.

This newsletter is published four times a year by the
MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION
P.O. Box 252, Mountain View, CA 94042
www.mountainviewhistorical.org

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Memorial & Remembrances: Vacant
Programs: Bob Weaver
Publicity: Jess Casey

In Memoriam
Donna Mae Martin
July 9, 2014

News & Notes

President's Message

By Patricia Figueroa
MVHA President

Hi Everyone,

This September 9th was the 60th Anniversary of the Mountain View Historical Association and we had an early birthday party at our Summer BBQ. And what a BBQ it was– a sellout crowd! Thanks to all for coming and sorry to those who we weren't able to accommodate.

The theme of the BBQ was "Linda's Parisian Burgers," and we were very pleased to have the owner of Linda's join us, Rebecca Riggs, along with her daughters JoEllen Dunn and Linda Bell (the drive-in's namesake). They so kindly gave us their recipe for the "special sauce" which seems to have been enjoyed by all. The BBQ requires a lot of hands working before, during, and after, and we wouldn't have been able to serve 150 Parisian Burgers without our volunteers! Thanks to all who helped make the BBQ such a success.

Parisian Burgers at the BBQ is the most recent example of how the MVHA is trying to more actively engage our existing members while also reaching out to potential new members. Doing so is critical to ensure the MVHA remains vital for another 60 years. Much progress has already been made, including the following:

- Updating our publications (brochures, newsletter, etc.)
- Creating a robust presence on-line (613 "likes" on facebook!)
- Participating in community events (More info on Page 3)
- Developing compelling programs for our Adobe Building events
- Public displays of our images/archival info. (More info on Page 3)

But there is still much more work to be done! For many years, building a museum at Cuesta Park was the focus of our organization. With those plans shelved, we have focused on building a stronger MVHA, one that will be better positioned to help fulfill our mission to preserve and share Mountain View's history.

The next step in this on-going process is our upcoming membership meeting on November 2. In addition to our planned program on NASA Ames Research Center's 75th, we will be electing new Executive Officers. Due to other commitments, Vice-President Cliff Del Carlo will be stepping off the Board. Cliff's dedication and service to the MVHA Board has been invaluable, and he will be missed. Candace Bowers, a librarian who frequently works in the History Center, has accepted a nomination to replace Cliff as Vice-President.

The rest of the Executive Committee, which consists of myself (President), Jamil Shaikh (Secretary) and John Figueroa (Treasurer) have accepted nominations for another two-year term. While we are happy to continue to serve this organization, there is a collective desire among the Board to develop new leadership. If anyone is interested in these or other Board positions, please contact me.

Another important reason to attend our November 2 meeting: We need your input on the future of the organization! We will be distributing a survey to everyone in attendance that will help the Board make plans for 2015 and beyond. Don't forget that Daylight Saving Time ends that morning, and we need to adjust our clocks "back" an hour on that day. Hope to see you there at 1PM!

Financial Report

By John Figueroa
Treasurer

Checking Account Balance as of 6/11/14: $ 5,846.30
- Income: $2,508.04
- Expenses: $2,628.40

Checking Account Balance as of 9/3/14: $ 5,725.94

Certificates of Deposit Balance as of 6/11/14: $83,017.71
Certificates of Deposit Balance as of 9/3/14: $83,045.85

History Center Update

By Candace Bowers
Historical Data Chair

Editor's Note: *Thanks to Candace Bowers for stepping in as the writer of our History Center column. Candace is a long-time Mtn. View librarian and will staff the History Center on Tuesday afternoon. See Page 4 to learn about opportunities to volunteer at the History Center.*

From Member Bettie Tognami: Assorted photos related to Mtn. View High from the late 1930s/early 1940s. (see below)

From The Riggs Family: Birds-eye view of their family restaurant (Linda's Drive-In) in the 1970s.



MVHS Football Team Photo Courtesy Bettie Tognami

The History Center

Mountain View Public Library, 2nd Floor
585 Franklin Street, Mtn. View, CA 94041

Open from 1-5pm every Tuesday & by appointment.
Call 650-903-6890 for more information.

The Mtn. History Center's mission is to collect, organize and make available Mountain View historical resources and to promote the city's heritage. It contains the historic archives of both the MVHA and the Mtn. View Public Library. Mtn. View history books and pamphlets are also available for purchase at the History Center.

MVHA Gets Involved

By Patricia Figueroa & Nick Perry

The MVHA had a busy Summer! Here is a brief rundown of some recent community events/projects we've taken part in, as well as updates on some future events:

Firefighters Pancake Breakfast: The MVHA was happy to donate a basket for auction at the 10th Annual Firefighters' Pancake Breakfast on Sept. 20. Our basket included books on Mtn. View history, a shirt, and annual MVHA membership.

Mtn. View Rotary 90th Anniversary: Newsletter Editor Nick Perry represented the MVHA as the featured guest speaker at MV Rotary's 90th Anniversary Dinner on September 18.

Bryant Park Plaza: Board members were guests at the ribbon cutting of Bryant Park Plaza on July 18. The MVHA has worked closely with developer Roger Burnell to create an interactive history display on the building's facade. The display is almost ready for debut - stay tuned!

Library Display: Over the Summer, the lobby of the Mtn. View Library had a Mtn. View History Display set up by Vice-President Cliff Del Carlo and Past President Bob Weaver.

FUTURE EVENTS:

Sister City 40th Anniversary: On February 7, 2015 the Mtn. View Sister City Affiliation will be hosting the 40th Anniversary our Sister City Affiliation with Iwata, Japan. A large delegation from Iwata will be visiting Mtn. View four for days. Sister Cities is seeking Mtn. View students interested in a two-week exchange program with a student from Japan for 2015-2016. For more info. contact Pat Figueroa at *patfig@ix.netcom.com*

Leadership Mountain View Partnership: The MVHA is coordinating with the Chamber of Commerce to offer a class on Mtn. View history as part of the Chamber's "Leadership Mountain View" program.

If you are a member of another Mtn. View community group that may be interested in partnering with the MVHA on a project or event, please let us know!



Bryant Park Plaza History Display Preview

Street Talk



90 years ago the Minton Company unveiled the Palmita Park subdivision. Consisting of Loreto, Velarde, and Anza Streets, the subdivision was the largest addition to Mtn. View in the 1920s. Today, the neighborhood is a cherished part of what was then known as "New Mtn. View" but is now known as "Old Mtn. View." Below is an excerpt from an article in the Jan. 24, 1924 edition of the *Mtn. View Register-Leader* describing how the subdivision's streets got its name.

WHERE DID PALMITA PARK GET THE NAMES FOR ITS STREETS?

Among those ranking highest in the zeal with which they explored the then mysterious country of California was one Father Kino. Although he made many explorations of note, his chief discovery proved that California, as then known, was not an island as believed but part of the main continent of America and could be reached from the interior of Mexico as well as by the water route along the Pacific Coast.

On this occasion, after long and toilsome progress up from lower California, the honor of actual discovery lay with the lieutenant Father Manuel de la Ojuela y Velarde. Velarde climbed a tall mountain and looking down from its "dizzy height" as he says in records of that expedition, he saw the head of the Gulf of California and "A port of three or four leagues in circuit," which forms its northern extremity, and the mouth of "the full flooded Colorado." In honor of Velarde, one of the streets of the new Palmita Park subdivision has been named.

On Father Kino's expedition he carried always a picture of Our Lady of Loreto. This practice was also followed by many of the other early explorers. It was thought by so doing that the way that lay before them would become pleasant. It was therefore fitting, in keeping with this belief, that Loreto was the name given to the first mission established in the whole territory of California. Loreto has also been adopted as the name of one of the streets of the new subdivision.

The third street for the Palmita Park Tract is Anza. This name was chosen to honor Juan Bautista de Anza the founder of San Francisco, one of the early explorers who did as much or more than any other, of importance to us. At the expense of much toil, and in many cases almost starvation, he opened up routes of travel, which resulted later in the settlement of Monterey, San Francisco, and later our own San Jose district. In other words Anza was largely responsible for the development of middle or central California. It is interesting to note that his name was given to the middle street of the Palmita Park Tract.

Call for Volunteers



Help share Mountain View's History with the public. Volunteer with the MVHA!

Event Volunteers: The MVHA is looking for local members who can help us share Mountain View's history with the community. Unfortunately, due to lack of volunteers this year, we were unable to participate in the Art & Wine Festival and Thursday Night Live events in Downtown. We'd like to build a roster of volunteers who we can contact when volunteer opportunities arise. If you're interested in joining this list please e-mail us at mvha.newsletter@gmail.com or call MVHA President Pat Figueroa at 650-965-4783

History Center: With the retirement of Bobbie Kinchen and Betty Engberg, we are in immediate need of volunteers who can help maintain our archives and interact with the public at the History Center on the second floor of the library. Mountain View Librarian and MVHA member Candace Bowers is happy to train MVHA members interested in joining her volunteer team at the History Center. If you are interested, please contact Candace via e-mail at: *candace.bowers@mountainview.gov* or call 650-903-6890

60th Snapshots!

THANK YOU to everyone who joined us at our Summer BBQ! We had a fantastic turn out! About 150 people came to celebrate our 60th and chow down on our recreation of Mtn. View's favorite Mid-Century meal, the Parisian Burger from Linda's Drive-In. Here a some snapshots from the celebration.



Photos of MV landmarks from the 50s and 60s scroll on the screen as guests wait for their Parisian burgers.



Linda Riggs Bell (The namesake of Linda's Drive-In) and her step-daughter Mary next to the MVHA's "Little Linda's" BBQ set-up.



The MVHA's special guest, Rebecca Riggs, former owner of Linda's Drive-In!



Descendants of Mtn. View's Castro family.



Laura Brown and Helen Hughes (MVHA Hospitality Chair) busy in the kitchen making "super fries."



Jamil Shaikh (MVHA Secretary) and John Figueroa (MVHA Treasurer) ready to check-in BBQ guests.



Our Grill Masters: Vice Mayor John Inks, Ken Rosenberg, Daniel Del Carlo and Cliff Del Carlo (MVHA Vice President).



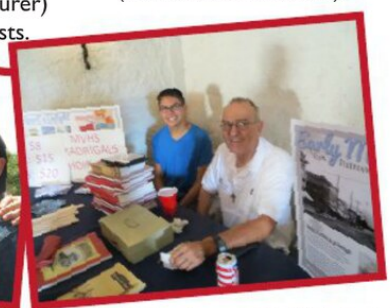
Bob Weaver (MVHA Past President & Program Chair) and Mary Kay Marinovich announce raffle winners.



MVHA cake!



Joella Garcia, Nick Perry (MVHA Newsletter Editor) and Jaime Garcia Ristedt



David Garcia and Sgt. Rick Espinosa (MVHA Ways & Means Chair) man the MVHA store.



Guests enjoy the beautiful weather and their Parisian burgers in the Adobe Building's garden.





Vice Mayor John Inks presents Mtn. View City Historian Barbara Kinchen with an official City Proclamation in honor of her years of dedicated volunteer service.

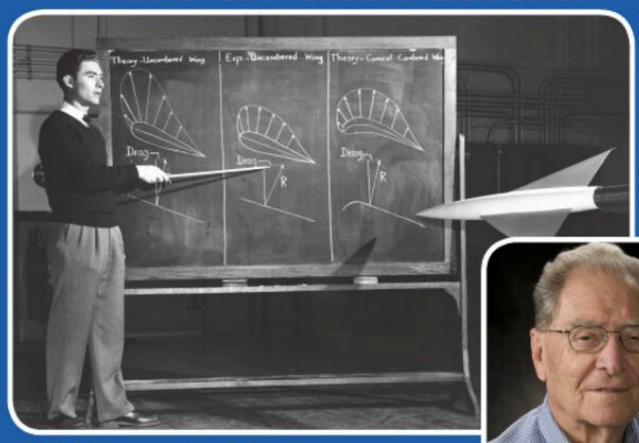
Fall 2014 Event Preview

Free Event! Guests Welcome!

ABOUT THE EVENT

The **Mountain View Historical Association** invites members and guests to attend our final Adobe Building event of 2014 where we will be celebrating the **75th Anniversary of NASA Ames Research Center.** We will also be electing MVHA's Board for 2015-16 and asking attendees for feedback on the MVHA's future plans via a survey (See Page 2 for more information). Our featured guest speaker will be **John "Jack" Boyd**, NASA Ames Senior Advisor for History. We hope you will join us as we explore the fascinating history of one of Mountain View's most futuristic institutions!

NOVEMBER 2, 2014
1PM – ADOBE BUILDING
157 MOFFET BLVD.
MTN. VIEW, CA



NASA images of Jack Boyd as a young man explaining conical camber at Ames Research Center (top), and a recent photo (right)

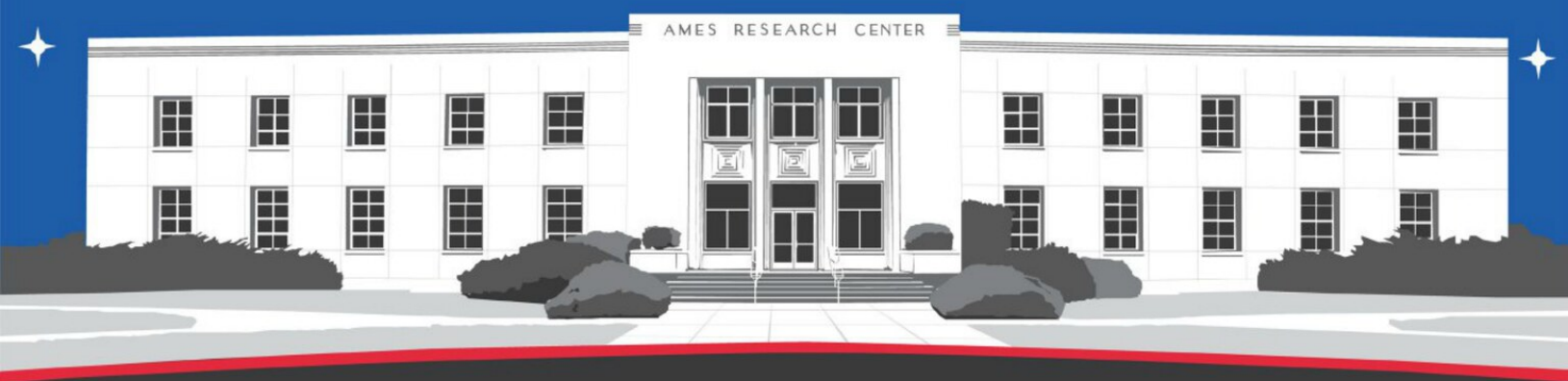
ABOUT OUR GUEST SPEAKER

John "Jack" Boyd began working at Ames Research Center in 1947 and has enjoyed a long and storied career as an aeronautical engineer, administrator, and educator. Jack's work as an aeronautical research engineer involved wind tunnel studies of supersonic and subsonic aircraft and included major contributions to theories of conical camber. He later did early research on the design of unpiloted planetary probes to explore Mars and Venus, and he helped develop early configurations for the Mercury, Gemini and Apollo capsules.

Beginning in the mid-1960s, Jack increasingly served in managerial positions at NASA Ames. Following eight years serving the University of Texas System, Jack returned to Ames to establish its Aerospace Encounter, an educational program for middle schoolers. In 2003 Jack retired from the Ames Director's Office to two full-time jobs, both of which are essentially educational in nature. As Center Ombuds, Jack hears privately about problems and tries to illuminate how the problem can be solved within the Ames culture. As Senior Advisor for History, Jack continues to lecture frequently about the culture of Ames and how its leadership has evolved to fit the needs of the time.

Jack returned to the Ames Director's Office as Senior Advisor in February 2006. In addition, he has his own research and writing projects and ensures that the work of the Ames History Office continues to explore how the Center's past is relevant to its future. The MVHA is very excited to have Jack as our guest speaker and looks forward to his talk on Ames's history titled "The Giants on Whose Shoulders We Stood."

75
NASA Ames
1939-2014



Membership

Membership Report

By June Casey
Membership Chair

Membership as of September 6, 2013

Honored Members	2
Life Members	115
Family Members	74
Single Members	114
TOTAL MEMBERSHIP	**305**

New Members: Shelly Walker Bacci & Donald Bacci, Adam and Katherine Blankenheimer, Lisa Garcia, Richard and Michele Forrest, Cynthia Hanson, Mark and Gloria Perry, Lisa Matichak, and Tommi Walker.

We've passed a membership milestone - over 300 members! Thank you all and a warm welcome to all our new members!

Join us today!

The Mountain View Historical Association welcomes new members. Any person who signifies interest in the aims of the Association and who pays the specified annual dues may become a member.

The aims of the MVHA are:

- To gather and preserve historical data relative to the early settlement and development of the area in and around the present City of Mountain View.
- To collect, record, edit and publish a history of the pioneering activities of this area
- To preserve historic objects and places
- To cooperate with other organizations in the Santa Clara Valley on projects deemed worthy by our membership

MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION

Membership Application & Renewal Form

- ☐ New membership
- ☐ Renewal
- ☐ REGULAR MEMBER: *$15/year*
- ☐ FAMILY MEMBER: *$25/year*
- ☐ LIFE TIME MEMBER: *$200*
- ☐ *I'm interested in volunteer opportunities*

NAME: _____

ADDRESS: _____

CITY: _____

STATE: _____ ZIP: _____

TELEPHONE: _____

E-MAIL: _____

Please make checks payable to:
Mountain View Historical Association

Mail to:
Mountain View Historical Association
PO Box 252, Mountain View, CA 94042

Fall/Winter 2014 Events

MVHA Fall Event & Membership Meeting



Jack Boyd – NASA Ames Senior Advisor on History

NOV. 2, 2014 at 1PM - ADOBE BUILDING - 157 MOFFETT BLVD

More Details on Page 6

October 24-25 2014
Friends of the R' House Presents:
"History Meets Haunting"
Rengstorff House, Shoreline Park
For more information visit:
www.r-house.org

December 8, 2014
Holiday Tree Lighting Celebration
Civic Center Plaza, 5:30pm

December 10, 2014
MVHA Board Meeting
Fire Station #4, 6pm
Interested Members encouraged to attend!

1954-2014
60
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MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION
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